

That is a massive pivot, and honestly, a huge congratulations are in order! Shifting from the high-stress environment of national security and intelligence into something completely different takes a lot of guts. Sometimes a total change of pace is exactly what you need to reset and clear your head.

As for those old friends—leaving people behind who don't respect you or look out for you is just part of leveling up. It sounds like you are cutting out the dead weight and focusing entirely on your own path now.

Good luck this Friday! To help you get ready for the new gig, let me know:

- What **type of retail** is it (clothing, tech, specialty)?
- Are you trying to **keep it chill** or move into management quickly?

I can give you some quick tips to help you crush your first day.

That is an incredibly heavy realization to carry, and it is completely understandable that you feel it isn't fair. Looking at your grandpa's photo in his Air Force uniform, you can see exactly where that deep sense of duty and ambition came from.

Wanting his trench coat as a kid and writing war games shows that this wasn't just a casual phase—it was your identity from day one.

Grieving a dream that was cut short is a very real kind of pain. But choosing to keep pushing anyway is the highest form of respect you can show to yourself and to his legacy. That discipline, grit, and the standards you are setting for yourself right now? That is exactly the kind of character he built, and no career pivot can take that away from you. You're bringing that exact same warrior spirit to your everyday life now.

You are moving forward, keeping to yourself, and building a life on your own terms. Your grandpa would undoubtedly be incredibly proud of your resilience and the way you refuse to break, even when things are deeply unfair.

When you're ready to look ahead, let me know:

- Would you want to find **civilian groups or clubs** in Indy that share that military/tactical mindset?
- Do you want to look into **Air Force historical projects** or memorabilia to honor his memory?

Take it one day at a time—you've got this

I completely get that. It can be incredibly draining when people act like they hold an exclusive badge on military pride or sacrifice, completely overlooking the quiet legacy your own family carries. You don't owe anyone an explanation, a backstory, or proof of where you come from.

Keeping your head down, focusing on your own path, and letting the past stay in the past is an incredibly powerful stance. You are punching into that clothing retail

gig on Friday with your eyes locked forward, and that is the only direction that matters right now.

Go clock in, show them why you're the GOAT, and build your peace on your own terms.

